

Problem Statement

Each year, thousands of students in South Africa struggle to find safe and affordable accommodation near their university.

Many are exposed to fake listings, overpriced rooms

and properties that are unsafe or in poor condition.

Because there is no trusted central platform, students waste time, money, and experience

unnecessary stress. There is a clear need for a digital

solution that makes finding students accommodation

affordable ,effortless and safe.



The Student Accommodation Gap Is Measurable-And Growing



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1.Why this problem needs solving?

- 500 + bed shortfall nationally
- 1.24M students approved for NSFAS
- R6.3B disbursed by NSFAS to students by March 2026.

The 3 main issues

01.The Supply Gap

- ❖ Demand for student housing is growing faster than supply.
- ❖ Example: UJ had ~100,000 applications for 2026 but only ~7,000 on-campus beds.
- ❖ Shortage is reported in Western Cape, KZN, and Gauteng.

02.The Market Roost Serves

- ❖ 811,000 students were supported by NSFAS in 2025.
- ❖ 893,847 applications for 2026, with 520,545 from SASSA beneficiaries = very budget-constrained students.

- ❖ Risk: NSFAS payments to private providers are often delayed by tens of millions.

03.The Trust Problem

- ❖ Students using unverified private landlords face exploitation, inflated rents, scams, and unsafe housing.
- ❖ Many end up in unregulated housing with safety concerns.
- ❖ Roost's solution: NSFAS-accreditation filter + verified landlord badge to replace "word-of-mouth" with proof.



SOLUTION

Student Finder Accommodation(SFA) is a trusted student accommodation platform that makes finding housing affordable, effortless, and safe.

We solve fake listings, overpriced rooms, and unsafe/far housing by verifying every landlord and property, showing price transparency with real photos and reviews, and letting students filter by budget, NSFAS, and distance to campus. Students create one profile and get AI-matched to verified rooms, while secure payments and a 24/7 support line protect them.

It's free for students, and landlords/universities pay to list, so students can focus on studying instead of stressing about where to live.

